

PAPER 2: CONFLICT IN THE MIDDLE EAST, 1945-1995

KT₁

Assessment Question: Why has peace proved so elusive in the Middle East?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT1: Geography of the Middle East			
L2: KT1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949			
L3: KT1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War			
L4: KT1.3: Increased Tension, 1955–1963			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT1: Geography of the Middle East

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the key countries and capital cities involved in the Arab-Israeli conflict.
- ☐ Locate strategic chokepoints and contested regions.
- ☐ Locate and label the Occupied Territories (West Bank, Gaza Strip, Golan Heights, Sinai Peninsula).

Map Task: The Geopolitical Landscape

Understanding the geography of the Middle East is the essential first step to understanding its history. The borders of the modern Middle East were largely drawn by Britain and France following the collapse of the Ottoman Empire at the end of the First World War. These artificially imposed borders laid the groundwork for decades of instability.

At the heart of the conflict are several highly contested regions: the Gaza Strip, the West Bank, the Golan Heights, and the Sinai Peninsula. Additionally, control over strategic waterways—like the Suez Canal, the Straits of Tiran, and the River Jordan—has repeatedly triggered military escalation.

Map Task: The Geopolitical Landscape

Source A

Reference Map



Scaffolding & Hints:

- Look carefully at the coastal outlines to locate the Mediterranean and Red Seas.
- Remember that the Sinai Peninsula connects Africa to Asia.

Q1. Using the blank map provided in your workbook (or the interactive map here), label the following: - Countries: Israel, Egypt, Syria, Jordan, Lebanon, Iraq, Iran - Capitals: Jerusalem, Tel Aviv, Cairo, Damascus, Amman, Beirut - Waterways: Suez Canal, Straits of Tiran, Gulf of Aqaba, Red Sea, River Jordan, Mediterranean Sea - Contested Zones (shade these): Sinai Peninsula, Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank

General Notes

[illegible]

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:



L2: KT1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.
- ☐ Analyze the key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.
- ☐ Describe the key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

In 1945, the world was reeling from the horrors of the Holocaust, creating immense international pressure for a Jewish homeland. Yet, for the Arab population of Palestine, this meant the terrifying prospect of losing their ancestral land. The British, exhausted and bankrupt from World War Two, were caught in the middle of an impossible situation.

Did you know?

- 1917: The Balfour Declaration originally promised British support for a national home for the Jewish people.
- 100,000: The number of Jewish Holocaust survivors US President Truman demanded Britain immediately allow into Palestine.
- 1947: The year Britain gave up and handed the Palestine problem to the newly created United Nations.

Source A : The Ruins of the King David Hotel, 1946



The southern wing of the King David Hotel in Jerusalem following the Irgun bomb attack on 22 July 1946.

Q1. What impact did the King David Hotel bombing have on the British Mandate?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 3

1.



Who is this historical figure, and what did he controversially promise in 1917?

2. How many Jewish people were systematically murdered during the Holocaust (1939-1945)?

3. At the end of WWII in 1945, what happened to hundreds of thousands of Jewish survivors?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Mandate | Zionism | Irgun | Nakba

Your Sentence:

Q2. What was the 'dual obligation' that Britain faced under the League of Nations Mandate of Palestine?

Q3. Identify two reasons why Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin set a strict immigration quota of 1,500 Jewish immigrants per month.

Q4. What was the 'Jewish Insurgency' and which three Zionist groups united to launch it?

Q5. Describe the deadliest act of the insurgency on 22 July 1946 and explain its intended target.

Q6. How did the British public react to the 'Sergeants Affair', and what was the political result?

Q7. How did the United Nations Partition Plan (Resolution 181) divide the land of Palestine, and what was the reaction of the two communities?

Q8. What was the impact of the Deir Yassin massacre on the Palestinian Arab population in April 1948?

Q9. Describe the tactical advantage Israel gained during the first UN truce in June 1948.

Q10. Explain the conflicting historical views regarding the displacement of over 700,000 Palestinians during the 1948 war.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: If you were the British government in 1945, exhausted by WWII and facing attacks from Jewish paramilitaries, what would you have done with the Mandate?

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: The Debate over Plan Dalet

Historians sharply disagree on the nature of Plan D. Traditional Israeli historians argue it was a purely defensive necessity to secure besieged Jewish settlements before the Arab armies invaded. However, 'New Historians' like Ilan Pappé argue the text of Plan D proves it was a deliberate blueprint for the systematic ethnic cleansing of Palestinian Arabs from the future Jewish state.

1. Explain the importance of conflicting interests and demands of Arabs and Jews for the British Mandate. 1945-48. (8 marks)

2. Explain the importance of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946) for the ending of the British Mandate in 1947. (8 marks)

4. Explain one consequence of growing Jewish insurgency during the British Mandate 1946-1947. (4 marks)

3. Write a narrative account analysing the conflicting interests and demands of Arabs and Jews in the British Mandate 1945-47. (8 marks)

5. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of 1946-48 that led to the creation of Israel. (8 marks)

6. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Arab-Israeli war from 1948 to 1949. (8 marks)

General Notes

[illegible]

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L3: KT1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the territorial changes and their impact, including the refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- ☐ Understand the creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and the Law of Return (1950), and the importance of US aid to Israel.
- ☐ Analyze Israel's relations with Egypt in the aftermath of the war.

The moment Israel declared independence on 14 May 1948, five Arab armies invaded. What followed was a desperate fight for survival for the Israelis, and a catastrophic loss of land for the Palestinians—an event they remember as the 'Nakba' (Catastrophe). The map of the Middle East was forever redrawn.

Did you know?

- 700,000: The approximate number of Palestinian Arabs who fled or were expelled from their homes during the war.
- 78%: The amount of Mandatory Palestine that Israel controlled by the end of the war, far more than the UN Partition Plan.
- 1949: Armistice agreements were signed, but no Arab state officially recognised Israel's right to exist.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. In what month and year did the British Mandate officially end and the State of Israel get declared?

2. Which extreme Jewish paramilitary group carried out the bombing of the King David Hotel in July 1946?

3. What was the name of the British Foreign Secretary who ultimately decided to hand the Palestine Mandate over to the United Nations in 1947?

4. Under UN Resolution 181 (the 1947 Partition Plan), what percentage of Palestine was allocated to the proposed Jewish state, and what was to be the status of Jerusalem?

5. Give two reasons why the Arab League and Palestinian leaders rejected UN Resolution 181.

6. What was 'Plan Dalet' (Plan D), implemented by the Haganah in March 1948, and why is it a subject of intense historical debate?

7. Name the five sovereign Arab states that launched a coordinated invasion of Israel on 15 May 1948.

8. Explain how the first UN-brokered truce (starting 11 June 1948) changed the military balance of the 1948 War in Israel's favor.

9. Explain the significance of the Deir Yassin massacre (April 1948) for the subsequent Palestinian flight.

10. In a narrative account of the end of the British Mandate, how would you link the bombing of the King David Hotel to UN Resolution 181?

Vocabulary Check

*Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Green Line***

Q1. What happened to the remaining portions of mandate Palestine (the West Bank and Gaza Strip) following the 1948-49 war?

Q2. How did the United Nations attempt to cope with the vast humanitarian emergency created by the displacement of 700,000 Palestinian Arabs?

Q3. Why did both Israel and the Arab host states refuse to permanently integrate the Palestinian refugees into their societies?

Q4. Why was the establishment of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) in May 1948 highly significant for Israel's internal politics and national security?

Q5. Explain the demographic impact of the 1950 Law of Return on the new State of Israel.

Q6. Why did President Harry Truman authorise massive emergency loans and grants to Israel in its early years?

Q7. Describe two ways that Egypt attempted to strangle Israel economically and militarily in the early 1950s.

Q8. How did David Ben-Gurion attempt to deter Fedayeen border raids, and what was the consequence?

Q9. Explain one consequence of the territorial changes following the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli war. (4 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Why do you think the well-equipped Arab armies were defeated by the newly formed Israeli Defense Forces?

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

GCSE Exam Practice

Explain one consequence of the territorial changes following the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli war. (4 marks)

Exam Practice

1. Explain one consequence of the 1948-49 Arab-Israeli War. (4 marks)

2. Explain the importance of the Arab-Israeli conflict of 1948 for relations between Palestinians and Israelis. (8 marks)

3. Write a narrative account analysing the growth of Israel 1949-1954. (8 marks)

4. Explain the importance of US aid to Israel for the consolidation of the new state in the years 1949–54. (8 marks)

5. Explain the importance of Israel's early relations with Egypt for the stability of the region in the years 1949–54. (8 marks)

General Notes

[illegible]

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L4: KT1.3: Increased Tension, 1955–1963

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- ☐ Analyze the events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956.
- ☐ Evaluate the events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.

By the 1950s, the Cold War had arrived in the Middle East. Egypt's charismatic new leader, Gamal Abdel Nasser, emerged as a hero of Arab nationalism, willing to stand up to the old European empires and Israel. When he nationalised the Suez Canal, it triggered a global crisis that almost sparked World War Three.

Did you know?

- 1956: Nasser nationalised the Suez Canal, taking it back from British and French control.
- Protocol of Sèvres: A secret agreement where Israel, Britain, and France planned to invade Egypt together.
- Superpower Intervention: The US and Soviet Union forced Britain, France, and Israel to withdraw, humiliating the old empires.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. What is the historical name given to the 1949 armistice line that established Israel's borders after its victory in the first Arab-Israeli War?

2. Which neighbouring Arab country occupied and annexed the West Bank and East Jerusalem following the 1948–49 war?

3. What Arabic term, meaning "The Catastrophe," do Palestinians use to describe the 1948–49 war and its immediate consequences?

4. Approximately how many Palestinian Arabs became refugees as a result of the 1948–49 war, and what agency was set up by the UN in December 1949 to support them?

5. Give one reason why Israel strictly denied Palestinian refugees the "right of return," and one reason why Arab host states (except Jordan) refused to permanently integrate these refugees.

6. Explain the twofold significance of the Law of Return, passed by the Israeli Knesset in July 1950.

7. What was the value of the vital economic grant given to Israel by the US government in 1949, and what was the further amount provided by 1960?

8. Describe the two primary ways Egypt chose to economically choke the State of Israel in the years immediately following the 1949 armistice.

9. What were the Fedayeen, and how did Israel's official reprisal policy under David Ben-Gurion attempt to deal with them?

10. Write an analytical sentence linking the 1948-49 Arab-Israeli War to the creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF).

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Pan-Arabism | Czech Arms Deal | Nationalisation | Protocol of Sèvres | UNEF

Driven by the ideology of _____, _____ sought to modernize Egypt. Following the _____, the West refused to fund his dam project. In retaliation, Nasser announced the _____ of the Suez Canal. This led to the secret _____ where Israel, Britain, and France invaded Egypt. The conflict ended with the deployment of _____ peacekeepers in the Sinai.

Q1. What were Gamal Abdel Nasser’s immediate political and domestic objectives after taking power in Egypt?

Q2. Why did Israel launch a devastating reprisal raid on the Gaza Strip on 28 February 1955, and what was the result?

Q3. What was the significance of the 1955 Czech Arms Deal for the balance of power in the Middle East?

Q4. How did President Nasser respond when the United States and Great Britain abruptly withdrew their funding for the Aswan High Dam?

Q5. What was the secret Protocol of Sèvres in October 1956?

Q6. Explain how Britain and France planned to use an Israeli invasion of the Sinai as a pretext to retake the Suez Canal.

Q7. Why did the Anglo-French-Israeli conspiracy backfire and end in a humiliating retreat?

Q8. Identify two vital security guarantees Israel received in exchange for withdrawing its forces from the Sinai Peninsula.

Q9. Explain one consequence of the nationalisation of the Suez Canal in 1956. (4 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Why was the Suez Canal so important to Britain and France that they were willing to go to war over it?

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

GCSE Exam Practice

Explain one consequence of the Suez Crisis (1956) for the Middle East. (4 marks)

Exam Practice

1. Explain the importance of Israeli attacks on Gaza, 1955, for relations between Egypt and Israel. (8 marks)

2. Explain one consequence of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955. (4 marks)

3. Explain one consequence of the Suez Canal Crisis (1956). (4 marks)

5. Explain one consequence of the formation of the United Arab Republic, UAR, in 1958. (4 marks)

4. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Suez Canal Crisis (1956). (8 marks)

6. Explain the importance of the formation of the United Arab Republic, UAR, in 1958 for regional tension in the Middle East. (8 marks)

General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:
